

THE INDUSTRY

Even as the Finance Minister prepares the Budget, industries of different s



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PERSONAL TAXATION

★ Relief to the salaried class by increasing tax slabs and providing higher standard deduction and deduction under section 80C

◆ Different holding periods and tax rates for different asset classes when it comes to capital gains should become one common treatment for capital gains taxes

★ Under section 80D, ₹25,000 (₹50,000 for senior citizens) of health insurance premium is allowed as a deduction for individuals. Covid-19 has proven that this limit needs to rise significantly

◆ Make pension tax-free because the pension premium is already paid through taxable income

★ Give full deduction of interest on house property for self-occupied property from the current ₹2.5 lakh

—Teena Jain Kaushal



REAL ESTATE

★ Increase principal deduction limit under section 80C to ₹4 lakh per annum from ₹1.5 lakh to improve affordability for homebuyers

◆ Expand deduction limit for home loan interest under section 24 to ₹4 lakh from ₹2 lakh per annum to encourage homebuyers to purchase residential units

★ Tax holiday for affordable housing projects to boost supply. Additionally, increase the price band for affordable homes—up to ₹85 lakh for costlier markets like Mumbai from ₹45 lakh

◆ Single-window clearance and industry status for real estate

★ Reduce tax rate on long-term capital gains from real estate deals from the current 20 per cent; also reduce holding period for a property from 24 months to 12 months

—Arnab Dutta



START-UPS

★ Regulatory framework and infrastructure status for digital wallet companies; single-window clearance to register and operate in India under the supervision of relevant regulatory authorities

◆ Crypto investors should be allowed to offset and carry forward losses; TDS exemption limit should be raised to a reasonable level

★ Agri-allied and biotech start-ups expect financial support with loans and subsidies

◆ PE and VC firms expect equalisation of long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax for unlisted shares and public stock investments

★ Create a regime for higher domestic investor participation and rupee capital inflow. Expand the Fund of Funds (FoF) programme and align LTCG with public markets

—Sohini Mitter